

Zirou Chen

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Education

- 2020-2026 Ph.D. in Marketing, University of Toronto
– Advisor: Nitin Mehta
- 2015-2018 M.A. in Economics, University of Rochester
- 2011-2015 B.A. in Economics & B.S. in Mathematics, Wuhan University

Research Interests

Substantive: Economics of Digitization and AI, Media Consumption, Platform Strategy, Personalization
Methodological: Structural Modeling, Causal Inference, Game Theory

Working Papers

1. Predictive Accuracy, Consumer Search, and Personalized Recommendation, with Mengze Shi and Zemin Zhong
2. Gamification in Digital Consumption: Evidence from TikTok, with Nitin Mehta and Matthew Osborne
3. Preference for Diversity, with Ying Zeng, Jiajia Liu, and Jingyi Lu
4. Product Relevance, Consumer Search, and Competition, with Bing Jing and Mengze Shi

Publications

1. Comparing Human-Only, AI-Assisted, and AI-Led Teams on Assessing Research Reproducibility in Quantitative Social Science, *Forthcoming at PNAS*

Conference Presentation

1. 2025/06 Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy, University of California, Berkeley*
2. 2025/06 INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, Washington D.C.*
3. 2024/03 TD MDAL Grant Research Roundtable
4. 2023/12 Conference on AI, ML, and Business Analytics, Temple University
5. 2023/06 INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Miami
6. 2023/05 Empirical & Theoretical Symposium for Canadian Marketing Strategy, Queen's University
7. 2021/06 INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Rochester^v
8. 2019/07 International Conference on Game Theory, Stony Brook University

* indicates "attending but a coauthor presented the paper" | ^v indicates "virtual"

Invited Talks

1. 2025/11 KU School of Business, University of Kansas
2. 2025/11 Sy Syms School of Business, Yeshiva University
3. 2025/11 Stern School of Business, New York University
4. 2025/10 Leeds School of Business, University of Colorado Boulder
5. 2025/10 Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Hong Kong
6. 2025/10 School of Business, Hong Kong Baptist University
7. 2025/10 Faculty of Business Administration, University of Macau
8. 2025/10 College of Business, City University of Hong Kong
9. 2025/10 School of Economics and Management, Tsinghua University
10. 2025/10 NUS Business School, National University of Singapore
11. 2025/10 Antai College of Economics and Management, Shanghai Jiao Tong University
12. 2025/10 School of Management, Fudan University
13. 2025/10 School of Economics and Management, Tongji University
14. 2025/10 School of Management and Economics, Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen
15. 2025/10 Argyros College of Business and Economics, Chapman University

Grants and Awards

1. 2025 ISMS Doctoral Consortium Fellow, Washington DC
2. 2024 Management Analytics Research Cluster Fund (\$7000), University of Toronto
3. 2023 TD MDAL Research Grant (\$4000), University of Toronto
4. 2023 ISMS Doctoral Consortium Fellow, Miami
5. 2022-2023 BEAR/BI-Org Ph.D. Research Grant (\$5000), University of Toronto
6. 2021-2022 BEAR/BI-Org Ph.D. Research Grant (\$2000), University of Toronto
7. 2020-2025 Rotman School of Management Fellowship, University of Toronto
8. 2018-2020 Wallis Institute Fellowship (\$25000), University of Rochester
9. 2015-2018 Graduate Fellowship, University of Rochester
10. 2011-2015 First Prize Undergraduate Scholarship, Wuhan University

Miscellaneous

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent)

Computer Skills: Julia, R, Python, Stata, MATLAB, $\text{\LaTeX}$